



SRI LANKANS

A NATION OF TWO PEOPLES

A PEARL-SHAPED ISLAND JUST TO THE SOUTH OF INDIA, Sri Lanka is home to two distinct ethnic groups. Sinhalese account for three-quarters of the population, while the remainder are mostly Tamil. The

The changing face of work

Almost half of Sri Lanka's population works in agriculture, although manufacturing industries such as clothing and textiles account for more of the country's earnings. Women, who tend to do poorly paid, unskilled jobs, make up one-third of the labor force.



TEA PLANTATIONS

Sri Lanka is the world's largest exporter of tea. The crop was brought to the island by the British in 1849. Tea is grown at 3,000-8,000 ft (900-2,400 m) and is handpicked, mostly by female workers.



BUFFALO CART

This is still a common form of transportation in Sri Lanka. Traditional songs are sung by cart drivers to keep themselves awake during their long, solitary, nighttime journeys.

RUBBER TAPPING

Latex, the thick white sap of the rubber tree, is collected by cutting a spiral groove into the bark of the tree and suspending a metal cup below it. An expert tapper can handle as many as 400 rubber trees in a day.

KILLER ELEPHANTS



Cutouts of human figures are placed by the roadside to scare off wild elephants, which have been known to trample people to death in this area.



Puppets are used to enact stories from the Hindu epic, the *Ramayana*.